

Salazar Leathercraft — Commission Intake Notes

Shop

Salazar Leathercraft. Etsy shop and direct commissions. Operated by Ian Salazar, Las Cruces NM. Hides sourced from a small Tennessee tannery; hardware from a vendor in El Paso. Customer notes maintained alongside the Airtable inventory.

Active commissions (as of October 2026)

1. Custom journal cover — Albuquerque client. Order placed July 28 via Etsy custom request. Specification: 8.5 × 11 in cover, full vegetable-tanned, deep Mission floral tooling on the front with the client's initials on the back panel. 35 hours quoted. Deposit received (\$150 of \$400). Delivery committed for December 5, 2026.
2. Tooled belt — Las Cruces walk-in (referred by Marco). Specification: 1.5 in wide, geometric Southwest pattern, brass buckle from the El Paso vendor. 22 hours estimated. Cash deposit (\$75 of \$185). No delivery deadline — finish when finished.
3. Three matching keychains — small commission for a wedding party gift. Specification: simple floral, monogrammed. 5 hours each, 15 hours total. Paid in full upfront (\$95 total, three-piece price). Delivery for the wedding date, October 31. On the bench now.

Pricing notes

Hourly rate is implicit, not stated to customers. Effective rate works out to roughly \$8–10/hour on the larger commissions once materials are deducted. Higher on small pieces. The leatherwork is not the income; the county salary is the income. The leatherwork is the practice that keeps the hands and the patience working.

Materials inventory snapshot

Veg-tan hides: 2.5 hides in storage (single bend each, 8–10 oz). Reorder threshold: 1 hide. Hardware: brass buckles (8), nickel buckles (12), copper rivets (50+), edge dyes in stock for black, brown, tan, and the burgundy that Abuela Rosa prefers on her own pieces. Edge bevelers sharpened in September; should be good through the holiday push.

Holiday-season prep

October through December is the heaviest revenue window of the year. Block Saturday afternoons at the studio (after the Organ Mountains hike). Etsy shop set to vacation mode the week of Día de los Muertos so I can focus on the mercado in person.